CORE ITEM UPDATE · INDIA

Core Item Update: Sneakers 2026–27

The Indian sneaker is growing up.

Forecut Editorial · 11 October 2026



Overview

The Indian sneaker is growing up. Handcrafted leather and kantha-embroidered sneakers are emerging, wider lasts address Indian foot shapes, and sneakers have become acceptable for sangeet and mehendi.

2	3	0	0
INVEST	TEST	MAINTAIN	REDUCE

Invest: rising now. Test: emerging. Maintain: at its peak. Reduce: fading.

The details

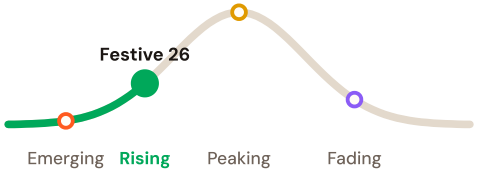
Each detail with its status for Festive 26, its trend curve and what it does next.



INVEST RISING

Retro gum-sole sneakers

Vintage trainers with suede overlays and gum soles. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.



Festive 26	Summer 27	Festive 27
Rising	Peaking	Peaking



INVEST RISING

Sneakers for the groom

Embellished or clean sneakers for sangeet and mehendi. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.



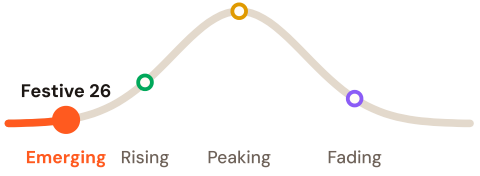
Festive 26	Summer 27	Festive 27
Rising	Peaking	Peaking



TEST EMERGING

Handcrafted leather sneakers

Full-grain leather sneakers made in India. Early signal. Trial in small drops and premium lines.



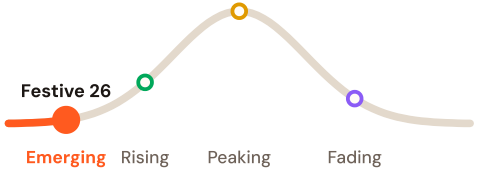
Festive 26	Summer 27	Festive 27
Emerging	Rising	Rising



TEST EMERGING

Kantha-embroidered sneakers

Suede sneakers with kantha embroidery. Early signal. Trial in small drops and premium lines.



Festive 26	Summer 27	Festive 27
Emerging	Rising	Rising

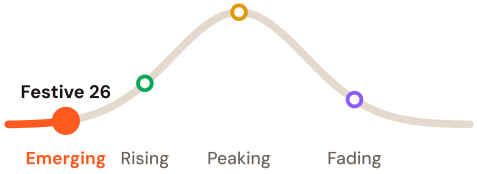


TEST

EMERGING

Wide lasts for Indian feet

Broader lasts shaped for Indian foot widths. Early signal. Trial in small drops and premium lines.



Festive 26	Summer 27	Festive 27
Emerging	Rising	Rising

How to update your sneakers range

- Test handcrafted leather and embroidered sneakers in small runs.
- Offer a wider-fit last.
- Market clean and embellished sneakers for the groom's pre-wedding functions.

See every sneakers detail with design notes and downloadable cards in the India Forecast 2026–27.

Statuses are Forecut's forecast for India: Festive 26 (Oct 2026 – Feb 2027), Summer 27 (Mar – Jul 2027) and Festive 27 (Aug – Dec 2027). Sources: India trends summarise public coverage of Lakmé Fashion Week x FDCI 2026 (Harper's Bazaar India, Free Press Journal), Aza Fashions festive and ethnic trend guides, Lashkaraa colour and silhouette trends 2026, Pearl Academy Gen Z trend reports, Gully Labs, Global Indian (Prada SS26 Kolhapuri-inspired sandals) and Outlook Business (Gen Z and e-retail).